IONUT-CRISTIAN FLORESCU

Hands-on Fractional CTO, Product Builder & OSS Author

Founder of swapp.ro. Creator of Mantine DataTable, Mantine ContextMenu, tRPC-SvelteKit, PocketBaseUML and other open-source projects trusted by developers and startups across the world, totaling nearly 3.9k stars on GitHub and 5.5+ million NPM downloads per year. Contributor to tRPC.io, Mantine, TanStack Application Builders.



CONTACT

github.com/icflorescu

linkedin.com/in/icflorescu

cal.com/icflorescu

ionut.florescu@gmail.com

+40 723 784 997

Bucharest, Romania, EU

RELEVANT SKILLS

TypeScript / JavaScript
★★★★★★

React / TanStack / Next.js
★★★★★★

Svelte & SvelteKit
★★★★☆☆

Node.js / Bun
★★★★★☆

UI - HTML / DOM / CSS
★★★★★★

DB - SQL / PostgreSQL
★★★★★☆

Software Design Patterns
★★★★★☆

AWS / Azure / Vercel
★★☆☆☆☆

Agentic coding workflows
★★★★★★

IN A NUTSHELL

I take software products from a blank repo to production, and stay to run them for a decade. **Building for the web since 1998.**

Hands-on fractional CTO and product builder: I still write production code, and I've also learned which code isn't worth writing. I work daily with AI coding agents, and know where they help and where they don't. Proud and passionate OSS author, contributor and maintainer.

Worked for small companies and multinational corporations between 1998 and 2007, with technologies ranging from PHP and MySQL to C#, Java & Oracle. Independent since 2008, as a founder, technical partner and catalyst for commercial and open-source projects.

Currently building with **TypeScript, React, TanStack Start, tRPC, Drizzle, PostgreSQL and Bun**, at home in rule-heavy domains (insurance, leasing, tax) where "almost right" means wrong.

Curious by nature, an avid reader of fantasy, fiction, business & tech-related literature, always looking to understand how things work and to make them work better.

RELEVANT WORK EXPERIENCE

Founder | Product Builder

swapp.ro

Since 2021

Invoicing and single-entry accounting for Romanian sole traders and liberal professionals, integrated with ANAF's e-Factura. Built in 2021 for my own books, rebuilt from scratch in 2026, solo, in five months: product, design and code. Live since October 2026.

- TanStack Start, React 19, TypeScript, tRPC
- Drizzle ORM & PostgreSQL, Bun
- e-Factura over ANAF OAuth, UBL invoices, background jobs
- 1,200+ unit tests, Playwright end-to-end tests
- Self-hosted with Docker & Caddy

HUMAN LANGUAGES

- English (C1 - C2)
- French (A1 - A2)
- Romanian (native)

LIKES & DISLIKES

👍 open-source
lazy mornings
good coffee
trekking in the mountains
reading fantasy

👎 willful ignorance
hypocrisy
xenophobia
people talking b...t

PERSONAL Q&A

What is your super power?
Curiosity.

What words of wisdom do you live by?
I know enough to know that I don't know everything.

Which founder do you most admire?
Certainly not Elon Musk.

What's the most creative thing you've ever done?
Being a consultant and co-editor for "The King's Host" fantasy novel.

What's an obstacle you've overcome?
Fear of rejection, hopefully.

MORE WORK EXPERIENCE

Fractional CTO | Technical Partner
OSS Author & Maintainer
@icflorescu
Since 2008

Capitalizing on the previous decade's achievements, I work independently as a fractional CTO, technical partner and open-source author, for customers across the world.

Acted as a founder, co-founder, technology partner and catalyst in various projects and initiatives, both commercial and open-source, owning them from design to implementation and operations, and feeling right at home working directly with founders and small-business owners.

Please refer to my GitHub profile for more info on the technologies I'm most comfortable with.

Technical Partner | Fractional CTO
LeasingSH.ro
Since 2013

Technical partner for Romania's first online marketplace for new and used cars in leasing or with cash payment, live since 2010. The platform lists 30,000+ cars from 750+ dealers across Romania and Germany, updated daily.

I took over the technical side in 2013 as a sweat-equity partner and have owned it end to end since: architecture, code, infrastructure, data and day-to-day operations. Rebuilt three times as the web evolved, keeping the business running through each migration.

V4 (2025 revamp, 1,100+ commits since October 2025)

- TypeScript, Next.js, React 19, tRPC, Mantine, Drizzle ORM & PostgreSQL, self-hosted with Docker & Caddy
- Data ingestion: scrapers for the main Romanian listing sites, a dealer API and an assisted mobile.de importer, with LLM-based enrichment and automated cleanup of makes, models and trims
- Custom image processing and storage for all listings
- Lead tracking across calls, WhatsApp and messages
- Admin console for dealers and partners, with an editorial CMS
- Public API with MCP and AI Actions descriptors for AI assistants
- SEO: structured data, sitemaps, IndexNow, Core Web Vitals

V3 (2015) and V2 (2013)

- Node.js, modern JavaScript, Jade/Pug, Knex.js & PostgreSQL
- Node.js, CoffeeScript, Jade/Pug, MongoDB, Amazon S3

FAVORITE STACK

- TypeScript
- React
- TanStack Start / Router / Query / Form
- tRPC
- Drizzle ORM & PostgreSQL
- Bun
- Mantine UI & shadcn/ui

IN MY OWN WORDS

"If coffee were a programming language, I'd be fluent."

"AI won't destroy humanity. Its misuse might, though."

"AI is inevitable. The returns on it aren't."

"Those closest to the system get acceleration. The rest get interpretation."

"Oil is finite. Fear is renewable."

LESSONS FROM MY JOURNEY

"When it comes to code, less is more."

"Becoming a field expert takes 10,000 hours, passion and curiosity. There are no shortcuts."

"Creating open-source software is hard work, offers no material rewards, and demands a lot of passion and dedication.
I have no rational explanation for doing it.
I'm probably just insane."

MORE WORK EXPERIENCE

Senior Full-Stack Developer

AJM Fleet Purchase

2020 — 2023

Built the automotive fleet purchase management application for AJM Business Services, an independent car trading company based in Belgium/Romania that specializes in B2B international fleet trading.

- React/Next.js, TypeScript, Blueprint.js + SCSS modules
- GraphQL / Hasura, PostgreSQL
- Amazon Lightsail with Docker, Amazon S3 storage

Tech Partner | Real-Estate Investment Advisor

Investment Romania

2008 — 2013

Following the experience accumulated while working for financial institutions, became part of a private-equity investment group focusing on the Bucharest residential real-estate market.

The perfect timing helped me break even, gaining a comfortable degree of financial independence and earning the privilege of being able to carefully pick my projects and work not only for money, but also for fun, challenge and to support my moral values.

From Software Developer to IT Manager in various companies

Allianz, Garanta/NBG, Frifugl, ANEVAR, etc.

1998 — 2007

Started my career in 1998, working as a network administrator for the first publicly-open Internet in Bucharest, then as a webmaster for the National Association of Romanian Valuers.

Worked as a web / software developer, from small companies such as Logic D&D Advertising and Frifugl Design AS to multinational financial corporations such as Allianz-Țiriac Romania and Garanta Insurance / National Bank of Greece, with PHP & MySQL, Java / J2EE + Sybase, and C#/.NET + Oracle & SQL Server.

While at Allianz, I was part of a core team of software engineers laying out the foundation of what was to become one of the best insurance software systems based on Microsoft .NET & Oracle RDBMS.

This is a short version of my resume; nearly three decades won't fit in a few pages. The full one is on LinkedIn, but I'd be happier if you visited my GitHub, which tells a better story of who I am, what I do and how I like to put my skills to use.

ARTICLES

The Ducks Have Landed
Oct 2026

I use AI every day and I'm not betting against it. The technology is real; the financials behind it are fragile.

On the Curious Selectivity of One-Way Flights
Jan 2026

Why calls for decisive action against authoritarian leaders are applied so selectively, and why tyrants are safest not when they are feared, but when they are profitable.

Introducing PocketBaseUML
Mar 2023

PocketBase comes with a fantastic UI (better than Supabase or Firebase, IMO), but I thought it was missing a graphical view of the database architecture. That's why I created PocketBaseUML, a free, open-source UML diagram generator/viewer.

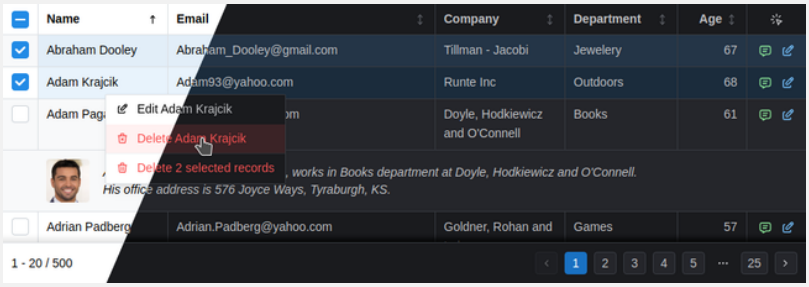
Lean diffs for browser-based text editors
Jan 2016

A study on the internal mechanics of online publishing systems, from blogs to social networks: some people produce content for others to read, and an important part of it is still the almighty text.

Open-source, capitalism and democracy
Nov 2014

I earn part of my living by building commercial software and web applications, and yet I'm also a contributor and keen advocate of free software and the open-source development model. Read the article to learn why.

OSS PROJECT SPOTLIGHT



Mantine DataTable

The lightweight, dependency-free table component that brings datagrid-like functionality to data-rich user interfaces built with Mantine UI framework, with dark-mode support and intuitive Gmail-style additive batch rows selection out of the box.

Since August 2022

Lightweight yet customizable

Supports asynchronous data loading, pagination, intuitive rows selection, column sorting, custom cell data rendering, context menus, row expansion, nesting and more.

TypeScript based

The entire codebase is written in TypeScript, options are well typed and documented with JSDoc, so you can build type-safe applications with confidence.

Free and open-source

Released under the MIT license, same as Mantine, so you can freely build fantastic data-rich applications with it.

Use anywhere

Works in any modern React framework supported by Mantine, such as Next.js, Vite, React Router or TanStack Start.

Trusted by awesome companies and developers

Used and trusted by developers across the world working in successful startups and projects: 1,250+ GitHub stars, 30 contributors, 249 releases, a legacy version still maintained for teams that can't upgrade yet, and over 500k monthly NPM downloads in October 2026.

Microsoft namecheap EasyWP
Aquarino kapa.ai exdatis
teachfloor ///MARKUP InvenTree
BookieBase zipline Pachtop